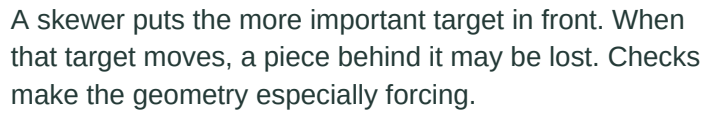


Skewers

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: knight on f3 and bishop on d3. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18...Qxh1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From h1 it attacks king on e1 and knight on f3. Recorded reply: **19.Ke2**.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +10. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +10: the balance goes from -6 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.